

POPCORN

"Popcorn Goes to School" follows the delicate and transformative journey of a little dinosaur on his very first day of school. Between the butterflies in his tummy, the wish to go back home, and a curiosity that insists on shining, Popcorn discovers that school can be much more than an unfamiliar place: it's where friendships, adventures, and learning are born... and even a few tears. In the midst of disputes and intense emotions, he realizes that the other can also be a mirror — reflecting fears, desires, comfort, and discoveries that belong to everyone. In this sensitive and playful story, every emotion Popcorn feels mirrors what so many children experience when taking their first steps away from the nest. By the end of the day, school is no longer something to fear — it becomes part of his heart.

GOES TO
SCHOOL

Leonardo Araújo

Popcorn Goes to School

Written by Leonardo Araújo

Illustrations created with the help of Sora and ChatGPT.

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To my parents, who gave me wings to fly.
To my wife, guardian of my castle.
And to my daughter, whose magic lights up our lives.

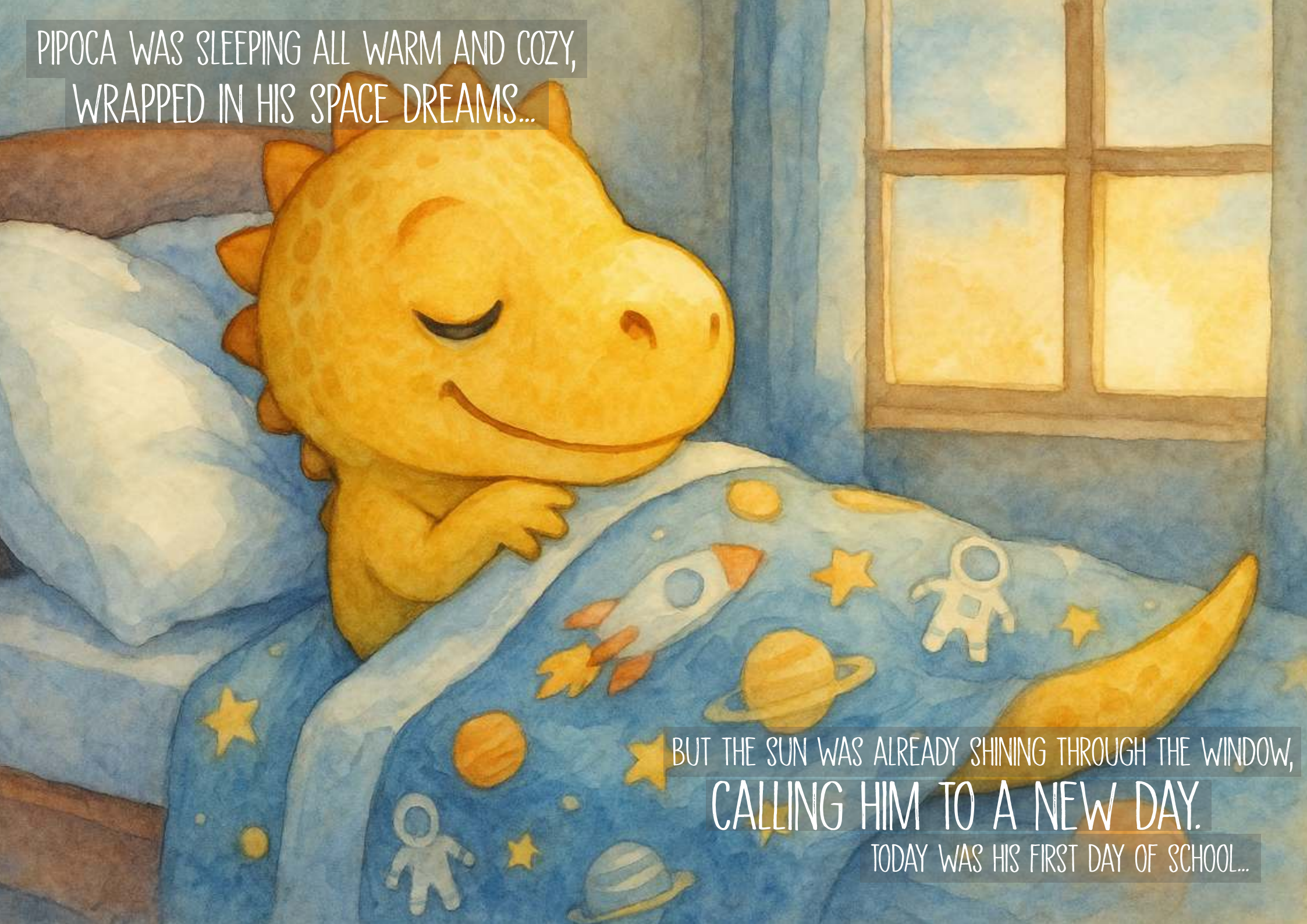
Dear readers,

This story was inspired by my daughter's adventure as she began school. It brings forth the fears, the anxieties, and the many joys of this very special moment. May Popcorn's journey serve as a bridge to help children face challenges and celebrate the joys of those first years at school.

Each story is unique, but the essence and magic within them is always the same.

With affection,
LEo





PIPOCA WAS SLEEPING ALL WARM AND COZY,
WRAPPED IN HIS SPACE DREAMS...

BUT THE SUN WAS ALREADY SHINING THROUGH THE WINDOW,
CALLING HIM TO A NEW DAY.

TODAY WAS HIS FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL...

PIPOCA FELT A SHIVER IN HIS BELLY...

WAS IT THE COLD MILK?



OR RESTLESS BUTTERFLIES FLUTTERING INSIDE?

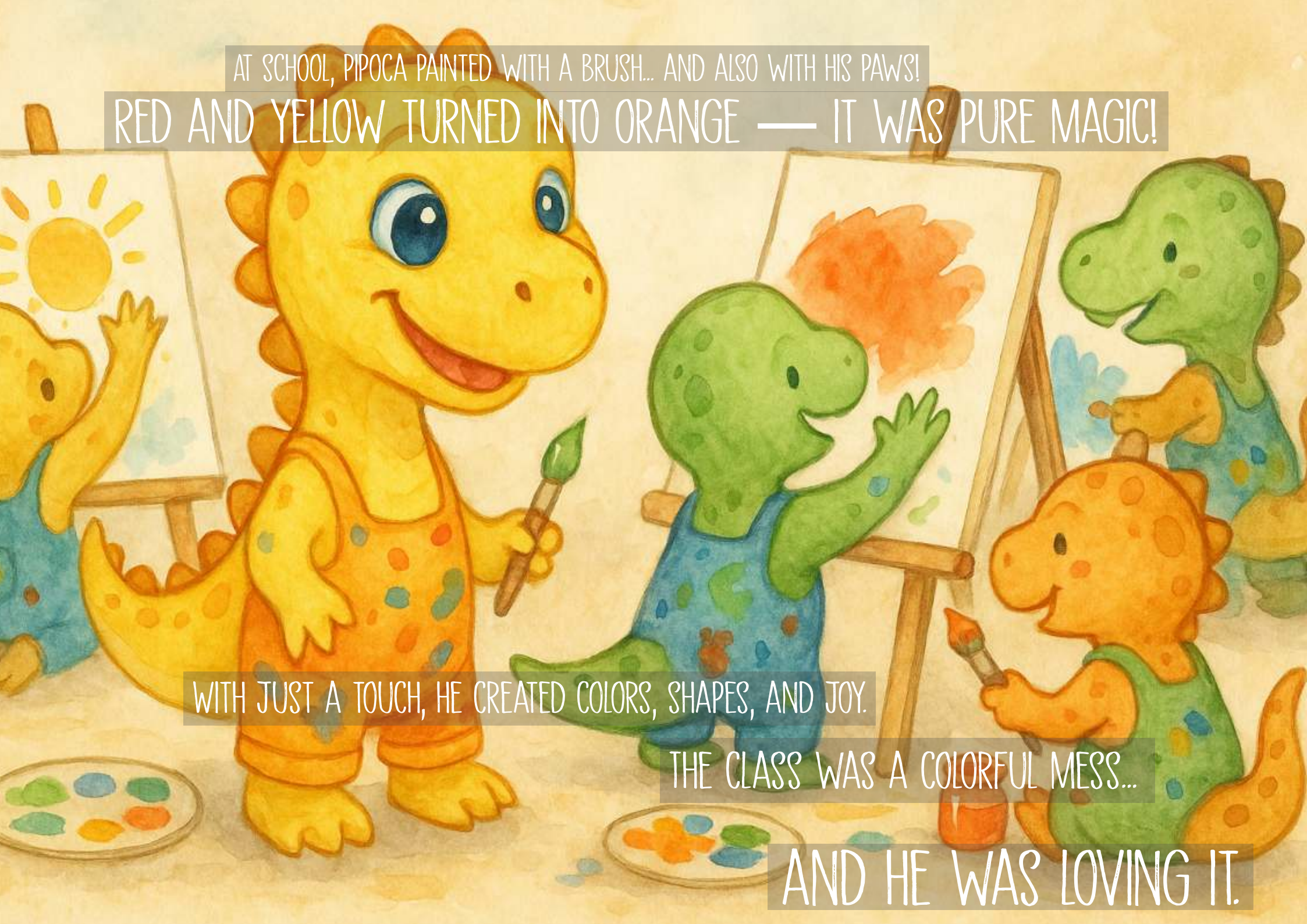
EVERYTHING WAS NEW...

ON THE WAY TO SCHOOL, PIPOCA STOPPED AND WHISPERED:
"I WANT TO GO BACK HOME..."



BUT THEN HE SAW OTHER LITTLE DINOS WALKING TOO.
A CHILL TOUCHED HIS CHEST...

AND A SPARK OF CURIOSITY
WARMED HIS HEART.



AT SCHOOL, PIPOCA PAINTED WITH A BRUSH... AND ALSO WITH HIS PAWS!
RED AND YELLOW TURNED INTO ORANGE — IT WAS PURE MAGIC!

WITH JUST A TOUCH, HE CREATED COLORS, SHAPES, AND JOY.

THE CLASS WAS A COLORFUL MESS...

AND HE WAS LOVING IT.

VROOOM!

THE RACETRACK WAS ALL FUN!



THEY ALL RACED TO SEE WHO WAS FASTEST.

PIPOCA FELT LIKE A CHAMPION.

A watercolor illustration of four dinosaurs in a classroom setting. A large yellow dinosaur with a blue eye and a wide smile is the central figure, standing behind two small wooden bongo drums. To its left, a smaller orange dinosaur is playing maracas. To the right, another orange dinosaur is playing an acoustic guitar, and a green dinosaur is holding a small golden bell. The background is a soft, textured wash of light green and yellow, suggesting a bright, airy room.

TUM-TUM!

PIPOCA DRUMMED OUT HIS JOYFUL RHYTHM.

THE CLASSROOM TURNED INTO AN ORCHESTRA.

MUSIC FILLED THE ROOM...

AND THEIR HEARTS TOO.

SUDDENLY... THE MUSIC STOPPED.

PIPOCA AND A CLASSMATE WERE FIGHTING OVER A TOY TRUCK.



HIS HEART POUNDED...

BUT THIS TIME IT WASN'T JOY.

IT WAS ANGER.

"I WISH I WERE HOME..."

THOUGHT PIPOCA.



SCHOOL DIDN'T FEEL COLORFUL ANYMORE.

A WHIRLWIND OF TEARS POURED DOWN NONSTOP.

PIPOCA WAS STILL QUIETLY SOBBING IN THE CORNER...

UNTIL LILA SLOWLY CAME OVER WITHOUT SAYING A WORD...

AND HANDED HIM A DRAWING.



WITH HIS HEART STILL TIGHT,
HE GAVE A LITTLE SIGH AND SMILED.

THE COLORS RETURNED. SADNESS SLOWLY SLIPPED AWAY.

ONE, TWO, THREE...

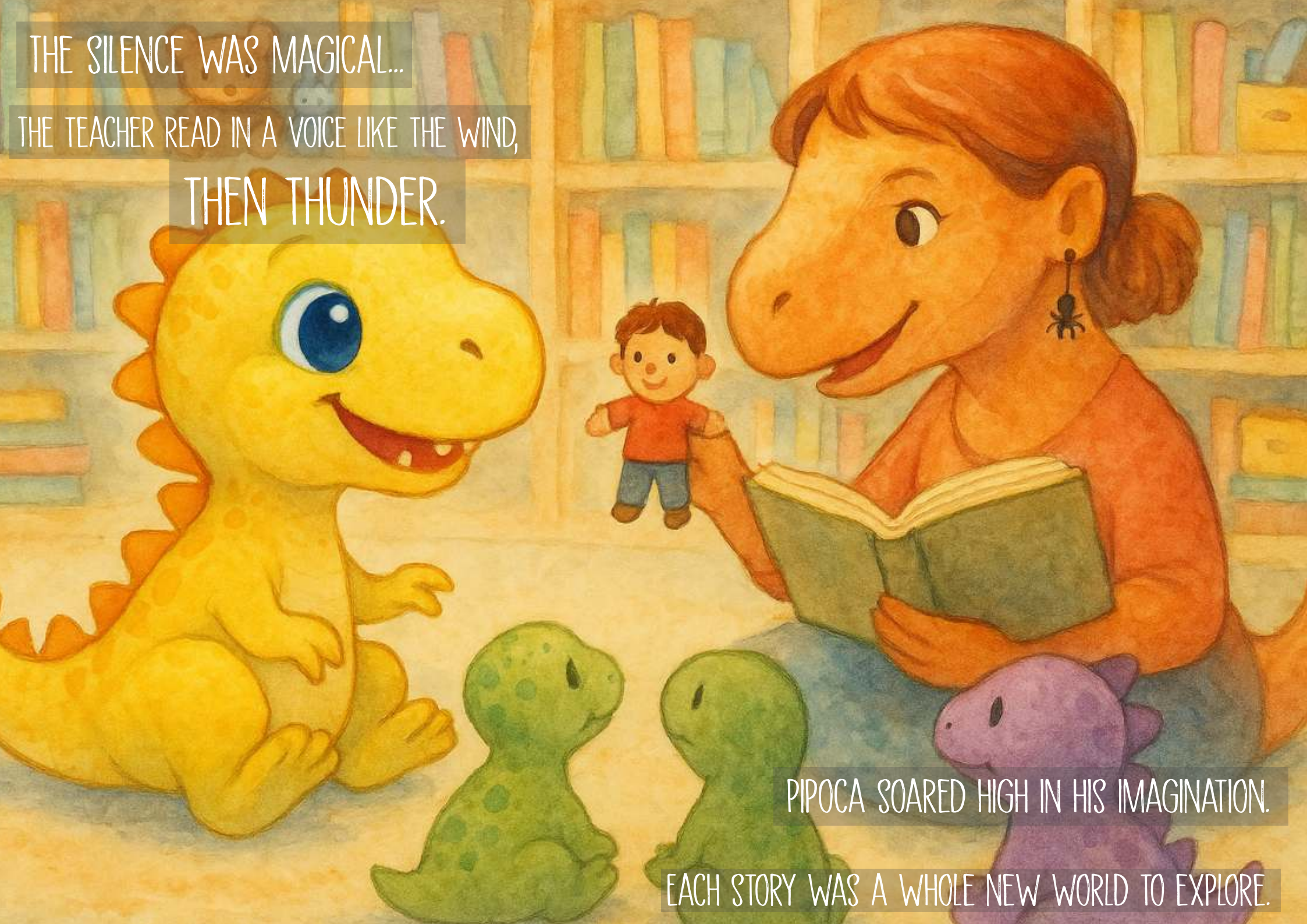
WITH EACH HOP, HIS HEART FELT LIGHTER.

AND FOR A MOMENT, HE FELT LIKE FLYING.



THE SILENCE WAS MAGICAL...

THE TEACHER READ IN A VOICE LIKE THE WIND,
THEN THUNDER.



PIPOCA SOARED HIGH IN HIS IMAGINATION.

EACH STORY WAS A WHOLE NEW WORLD TO EXPLORE.

AT HOME, PIPOCA BECAME THE TEACHER.

HIS STUFFED ANIMALS, DEVOTED STUDENTS.

HE TOLD STORIES, TAUGHT, AND PAINTED WITH THEM.

SCHOOL LIVED IN HIS HEART —
ALWAYS ALIVE, ALWAYS HIS.



Every change begins with butterflies in your tummy.
And it's in that fluttering that courage is born.
You have to step out to discover...
that we too have wings to soar into freedom.

